GUIDANCE NOTE — DRAFT

Wind class & site classification

The two letters on the engineering that have to match your actual site.

DRAFT — NOT PUBLISHED. The registered building surveyor to verify wording and any figures before release.

WIND CLASS (AS 4055): N1–N6

Every structure is engineered for a wind class, and the class belongs to the **site**, not the product. Around Perth (non-cyclonic Region A) most suburban lots land at **N1–N2**, but the same shed on a coastal, open-rural or hilltop lot can jump to N3 or higher. What moves it:

- **Terrain** — open water or paddocks versus built-up suburbia.
- **Shielding** — neighbouring buildings that break the wind, or the lack of them.
- **Topography** — crests, escarpments and slopes accelerate wind.

Generic "N2" brochure engineering on an exposed N3 site is the classic mismatch — and the first thing we check.

SITE CLASSIFICATION (AS 2870): A, S, M, H, E, P

The soil class drives footing and slab design — from **A/S** (sand, stable — most of the Perth coastal plain) through **M/H/E** (increasingly reactive clays, common in the hills and river soils) to **P** (problem sites: fill, variable ground). Slabs and footings must be designed for the class that exists, not assumed sand.

WHAT WE LOOK FOR AT ASSESSMENT

- ✓ The engineering **states a wind class**, and that class is plausible for the site's terrain, shielding and topography.
- ✓ Footing/slab details match the **soil class** — with a soil report where the ground is reactive, filled, or the engineer requires one.
- ✓ Site plan features that change the answer are visible: coastal frontage, open rural outlook, crest of a hill, cut and fill.

Not sure what your site is? Say so in the lodgement notes rather than guessing — confirming a wind or soil class early is quick; re-engineering after assessment is not. Our engineering-on-demand service can also close the gap.

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